

PROGRESSION • TIMELINE • GRAPH

state-chart

Native state machine diagram — states as a numbered list, transitions as nested inline-code refs.

SUBMISSION LIFECYCLE

States connect; the arrows carry the rules.

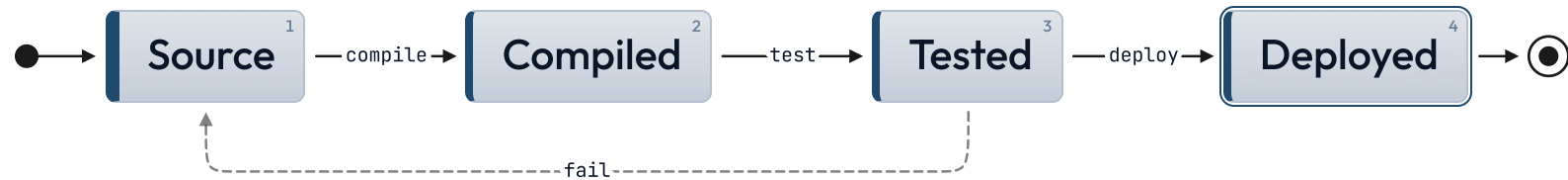
How a draft moves from author to publication.



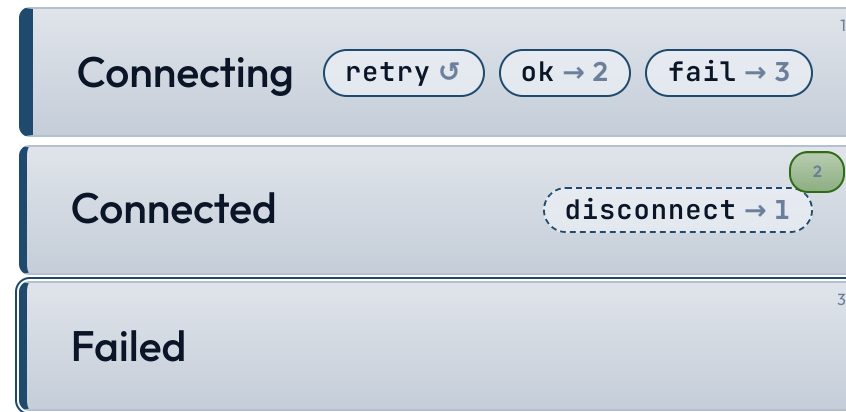
Rejected drafts return to the author; revisions stay in review.

● on-track ● at-risk

lr flows the states left to right.

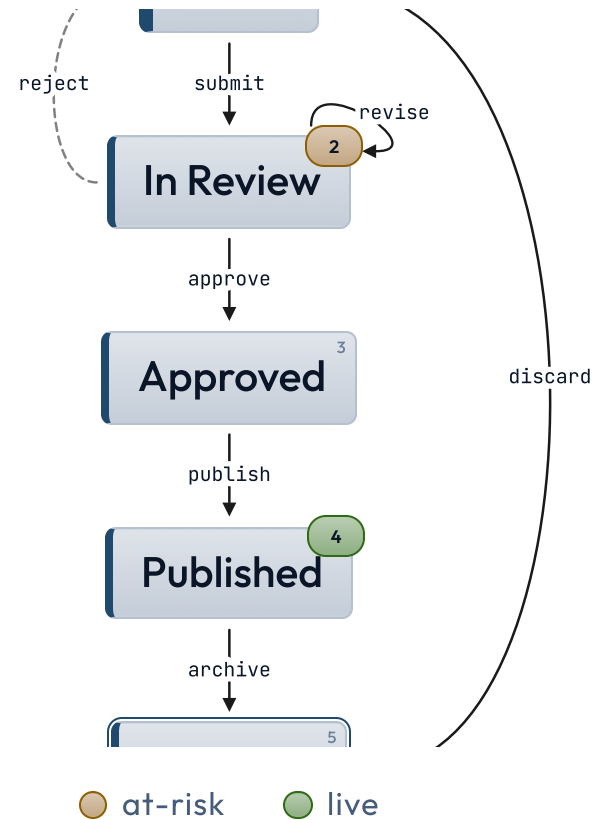


inline sets the chart beside its prose.



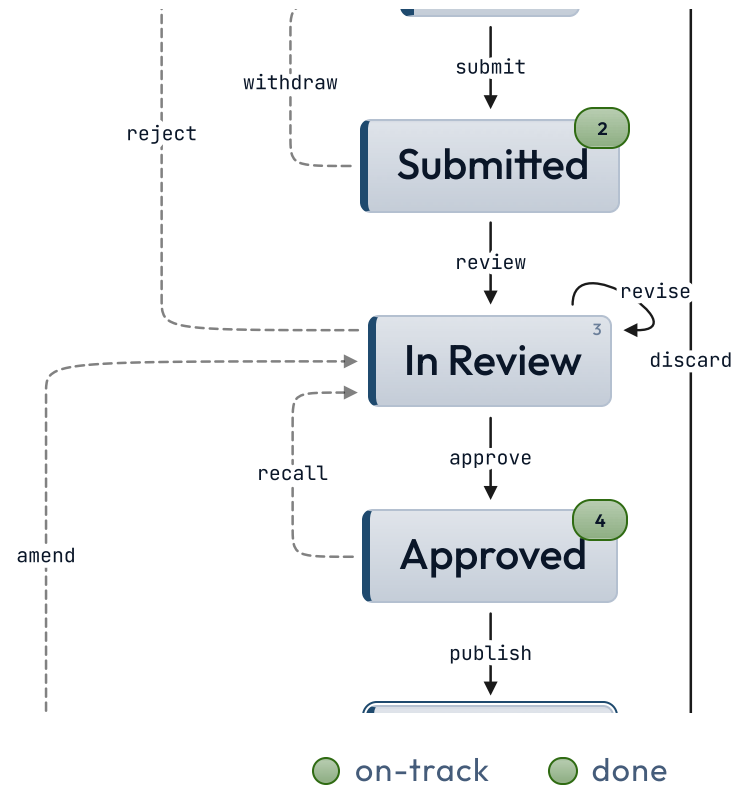
● live

curved eases the arrows between states.



SUBMISSION LIFECYCLE

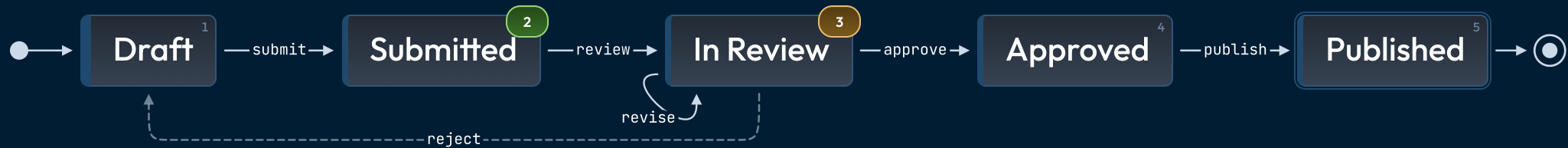
Stress test — back-edges, skips, self-loop.



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When NOT to reach for state-chart.

More than ~8 states. Vertical stacks of ten or more states stop reading as a machine and start reading as a list. If the system has many states, group them into phases and show one phase at a time, or step back to a higher-level abstraction. The chart's job is to make the topology obvious in one glance.

Hierarchical or parallel states. A grammar is one flat list of states does and this layout doesn't with one outgoing arrow per nested bullet. Composite states, `stateDiagram-v2` — belong in a `diagram` component. orthogonal regions, history nodes Mermaid

Continuous processes. If the diagram is really a workflow fence via the chart reads better. State charts with stages that overlap or block are for discrete, mutually-exclusive states the system flips between. (queue depth, throughput, capacity), `gantt` or `kanban`

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

diagram — the machine has hierarchical states, parallel regions, or guards that need Mermaid's full state-diagram grammar

journey — the sequence is a user's path through tasks with mood / affect, not a system's discrete states

timeline-list — events are points in time rather than transitions between named states

list-steps — a linear procedure with no branching — state-chart is overkill if there are no choices to make

roadmap — parallel workstreams across phases, not a single machine's transitions